Year 8 Admission Assessment

Version 3.1, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.

Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

- **Read** each question carefully.
- In **Maths** and **Science**, you can ask your teacher to read a question to you.
- In **Listening**, **Reading** and **Writing**, your teacher cannot explain words. We want to see your English.
- You need a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. You cannot use a calculator.

How to answer

Tick a box.

Which one is a city?

- ☐ apple
- ☑ Shanghai
- ☐ green

Write in a box.

7 + 5 = 12

Show your working.

25 × 12

Working

25 × 10 = 250

25 × 2 = 50

Answer 300

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	Listen to a conversation and a short talk. Answer 16 questions.	about 12 minutes
Reading	Read two texts. Answer the questions.	15 minutes
Writing	Choose one task. Write about 20 lines.	10 minutes
Break	Have a short rest.	5 minutes
Maths	Answer the questions in Sections A, B and C.	25 minutes
Science	Answer 7 questions.	8 minutes
Talk	Read some sentences aloud. Talk with a teacher about yourself and your plans.	15 minutes

Listening

There are two parts. Part B is harder. Do as much as you can.

Part A: Two students talking

Your teacher will read a conversation **two times**.

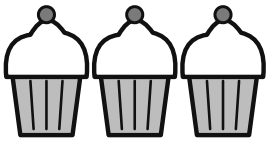
Two students, Mei and Amir, are talking about the school charity fair.

Read the questions now. Then **listen** and **answer** the questions.

1 / 1

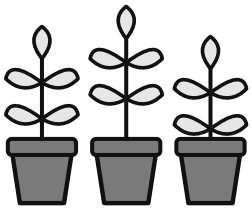
What will the class sell at the fair? **Tick** one box.

A



cakes ☐

B



plants ☐

C

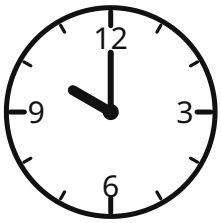


books ☐

2 / 1

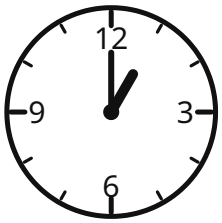
What time does the fair finish? **Tick** one box.

A



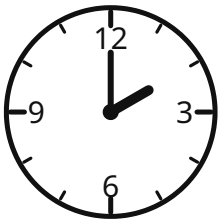
10:00 ☐

B



1:00 ☐

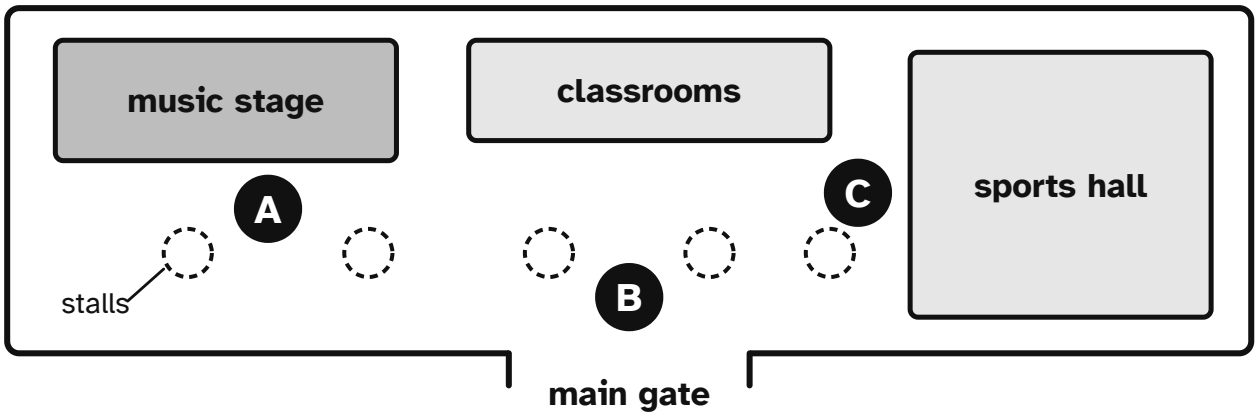
C



2:00 ☐

3 / 1

Where is the class stall this year? **Tick** one box.



☐ A ☐ B ☐ C

4 / 1

What will Amir do? **Tick** two boxes.

☐ make the price signs ☐ buy the plants ☐ bring a table ☐ play the piano

5 / 1

How many plants will Mei's aunt give the class? **Write** the number in the box.

☐

6 / 1

The class sells all the plants. How much money will they give to the charity? **Write** the number in the box.

☐ yuan

7 / 1

Amir will leave the fair before it finishes. Why? **Write** your answer.

8 / 1

Why is the main gate a better place for the stall than last year's place? **Write** one reason.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Part B: A short talk

Your teacher will read a talk **two times**.

Dr Lin, a scientist, is talking to a class about noise in cities.

Read questions 9 to 16 now. You have one minute. Then **listen** and **answer** the questions.

9 / 1

How loud is a normal conversation? **Write** the number in the box.

☐ decibels

10 / 1

A sound goes up by 10 decibels. How much louder does it seem to our ears? **Tick** one box.

☐ about twice as loud ☐ about ten times as loud ☐ about a hundred times as loud

11 / 1

A sudden sound reaches your ears. What happens next? **Write** 2, 3 and 4 in the boxes to show the order. Number 1 is done for you.

What happens	Order
A sudden sound reaches your ears.	**1**
Your heart beats faster.	
Your body releases stress hormones.	
Your brain treats the sound as a warning of danger.	

12 and 13

/ 2

Complete the notes. **Write** one, two or three words in each gap.

You hear: "Our class will visit the science museum on Friday."

You write: Class visit: science museum, on Friday

Notes: the Munich airport study

1992: the city of Munich moved its airport. Researchers tested children near the old airport and the new airport.

Near the new airport: the children's reading and **(12)** _____ became worse.

Near the old airport: the children's reading and memory **(13)** _____ .

14

/ 1

What does Dr Lin think about electric cars? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ She thinks they are the best way to make cities quieter.
- ☐ She thinks they help, but other changes may help more.
- ☐ She thinks they make cities noisier.

15

/ 1

In the new park, the noise is only a little lower than before. Why do visitors feel calmer there? **Use** ideas from different parts of the talk. **Write** your answer.

16

/ 1

What is the main purpose of Dr Lin's talk? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ to explain how scientists measure sound
- ☐ to compare the noise in different cities in Europe
- ☐ to show that noise harms health, and that cities do not have to be so noisy
- ☐ to argue that electric cars will solve the problem of noise

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Reading

Read the texts and **answer** the questions.

There are two parts: **A** and **B**. Part B is harder than Part A.

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

You have 15 minutes.

Part A: A notice

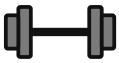
Read the notice. Then **answer** questions 1 to 6.

Greenway Sports Centre

Opening times

Monday to Friday	**7:00 to 21:00**
Saturday and Sunday	**8:00 to 18:00**

Prices

	**Swimming pool**	Adults: 30 yuan Students: 15 yuan
	**Badminton court**	40 yuan for one hour
	**Gym**	25 yuan Age 16 and over only

Students: please show your student card.

Lockers: you need a 2 yuan coin.

No food or drink in the pool area.

1 / 1

What time does the sports centre open on Saturday? **Write** your answer in the box.

2 / 1

How much is a swimming ticket for a student? **Write** your answer in the box.

3 / 1

Who can use the gym? **Write** your answer in the box.

4 / 1

What do you need to use a locker? **Write** your answer in the box.

5 / 3

Tick True or False for each sentence.

Example	True	False
The centre has a gym.	✓	

Sentence	True	False
a. The centre closes at 21:00 on Sunday.	☐	☐
b. A badminton court costs 40 yuan for one hour.	☐	☐
c. You can eat a snack in the pool area.	☐	☐

6 / 1

Li Na and Jun are 13. They both want to swim. They show their student cards. How much do they pay altogether? **Write** your answer in the box.

Part B: An article

Read the article. Then **answer** questions 7 to 13.

Sleep: why teenagers need more of it

If you find it hard to get up for school, you are not lazy. You are probably just a teenager.

Scientists who study sleep have found that the body clock changes in the early teenage years. This clock is controlled partly by melatonin, a chemical that makes us feel sleepy. In younger children, the body releases melatonin early in the evening. In teenagers, it is released up to two hours later. This means that a thirteen-year-old may not feel tired until eleven o'clock at night, even though they will be exhausted when the alarm rings the next morning.

At the same time, teenagers need a lot of sleep: between eight and ten hours a night, according to most sleep experts. Their bodies and brains are still developing, and much of this happens while they sleep. During deep sleep, the brain also sorts and stores what we have learnt during the day. So a student who sleeps well after studying is likely to remember more than a student who stays up late to study for longer.

Unfortunately, modern life makes good sleep harder. Phones and tablets give out a kind of blue light that tells the brain it is still daytime, and messages and videos keep the mind busy. Many students also have long days, with homework and extra classes in the evening.

So what can you do? Sleep experts suggest a few simple habits. Go to bed and get up at about the same time every day, even at weekends. Put your phone in another room an hour before bed. Keep your bedroom cool, dark and quiet. If something is worrying you, write it down before you sleep, so your mind can let it go until the morning.

Some schools around the world have started the school day later, and many report that their students are more alert in lessons. Until that happens everywhere, the best thing you can do is protect your own sleep. Your brain will thank you.

7 / 1

How many hours of sleep do teenagers need, according to the article? **Write** your answer in the box.

8 / 1

Why might a thirteen-year-old not feel sleepy at ten o'clock at night? **Write** your answer.

9 / 1

"They will be **exhausted** when the alarm rings." What does **exhausted** mean? **Tick** one box.

☐ very tired ☐ very hungry ☐ very late ☐ very happy

10 / 2

Which two pieces of advice are in the article? **Tick** two boxes.

☐ Drink a glass of warm milk before bed.
☐ Go to bed at about the same time every day.
☐ Study late at night before a test.
☐ Put your phone in another room an hour before bed.
☐ Sleep with a light on.

11 / 1

The article says a student who sleeps well after studying will probably remember more. Why? **Write** your answer.

12 / 1

The writer begins: "If you find it hard to get up for school, you are not lazy." Why do you think the writer begins like this? **Write** your answer.

13 / 1

What is the main purpose of the article? **Tick** one box.

☐ to tell a funny story ☐ to explain a problem and give advice

☐ to sell a new phone ☐ to complain about schools

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Writing

You have 10 minutes.

Choose one task. **Tick** the box for your task.

☐ **Task 1: A description**	☐ **Task 2: A speech**
Describe a busy place you know well. For example: a train station at Spring Festival, a night market, or a sports match.	Many students throw away food in the school canteen. **Write** a speech for your class. Persuade students to waste less food.
Ideas: What can you see, hear and smell? Who is there? How does it make you feel?	Ideas: Why is wasting food a problem? What can students do? Use strong reasons and examples.

Plan your writing in the box. You can write notes.

Plan

Write your answer on the lines. Try to write about 20 lines.

Check your writing: capital letters, full stops, spelling. Does it make sense?

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Maths

You have 25 minutes. You cannot use a calculator.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

Show your working. You can get marks for your working.

There are three sections: A, B and C. Do as much as you can.

Section A: Fluency

Work out the answers. **Write** each answer in the box.

1 / 1

Write 360 as a product of prime factors. **Give** your answer in index form.

Example: $72 = 2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 = 2^3 \times 3^2$

Working

360 =

2 / 2

a. **Write** the highest common factor (HCF) of 84 and 120.

b. **Write** the lowest common multiple (LCM) of 84 and 120.

Working

3 / 1

Write these numbers in order of size. Start with the smallest.

$\frac{2}{5}$ 0.38 37% $\frac{3}{8}$

Smallest first:

4 / 1

Expand and **simplify**

$3(2x - 5) - 2(x - 4)$

5 / 1

Factorise fully

$12x^2 - 18xy$

6 / 1

Solve $4(2x - 3) = 3(x + 6)$

Working

$x =$

7 / 1

Solve $11 - 3x > 2$

Working

8 / 1

Simplify $(y^4)^3 \div y^5$

9 / 1

Work out $(4 \times 10^5) \times (3 \times 10^3)$

Give your answer in standard form.

Example: $35\,000 = 3.5 \times 10^4$ in standard form.

Section B: Word questions

These questions are in words only. **Read** each question carefully. **Decide** what to do.

You can **write** an equation, then **solve** it.

Example: write an equation, then solve it.

I think of a number. I multiply it by 4, then I subtract 7. The answer is 33. What is my number?

Let the number be n.

Equation: $4n - 7 = 33$

Solve: $4n = 40$, so $n = 10$

My number is **10**.

10 / 2

The three angles in a triangle are $x°$, $2x°$ and $(x + 20)°$.

Work out the size of the largest angle.

Working

[ ] °

11 / 2

Three consecutive even numbers add up to 114.

(Consecutive even numbers follow each other, like 6, 8 and 10.)

What is the largest of the three numbers?

Working

[ ]

12 / 2

Amir and Sofia share some money in the ratio 3 : 5.

Sofia gets ¥24 more than Amir.

How much money is there altogether?

Working

¥ [ ]

13 / 2

Mei draws a rectangle. Its length is 3 times its width.

Then she draws a square. The side of the square is 4 cm shorter than the length of the rectangle. It is 4 cm longer than the width of the rectangle.

Work out the area of the rectangle.

Working

[ ] cm^2

Section C: Applied problems

14 / 2

The same jacket costs ¥600 in two shops. Both shops have a sale.

Shop A	Shop B
Jacket **¥600**	Jacket **¥600**
Sale: 20% off, then another 10% off the new price	**Sale:** 30% off

Mei says, "The sale price is the same in both shops."

Is Mei correct? **Show** your working.

Working

Tick one box. ☐ Yes ☐ No **Explain** your answer.

15 / 2

A bag has only red, blue and green counters. Li Na takes one counter without looking.

The table shows the probability of each colour.

Colour	**red**	**blue**	**green**
Probability	0.3	0.45	?

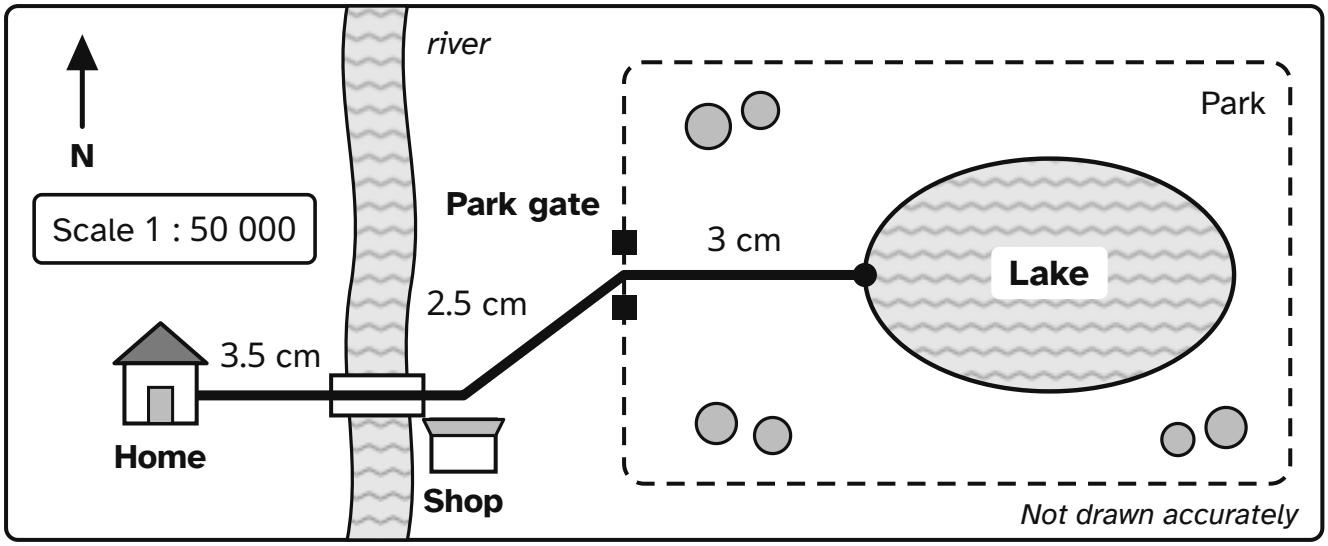
a. **Work out** the probability that the counter is green. ☐

b. There are 15 green counters in the bag. How many counters are in the bag altogether?

☐

Working

16 / 3



The map shows Chen Yu's route from her home to the lake. The lengths are measured on the map.

The scale of the map is 1 : 50 000.

Chen Yu cycles at an average speed of 15 km/h. She leaves home at 9:40.

At what time does she arrive at the lake?

Working

17

/ 3

Mei asks 20 students, "How many books did you read last month?" The table shows her results.

Number of books	**0**	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**
Number of students	1	5	6	5	3

a. **Work out** the mean number of books that these students read.

Working

b. Jun says, "The mean is 2, because (0 + 1 + 2 + 3 + 4) ÷ 5 = 2."

Explain why Jun is wrong.

18

/ 2

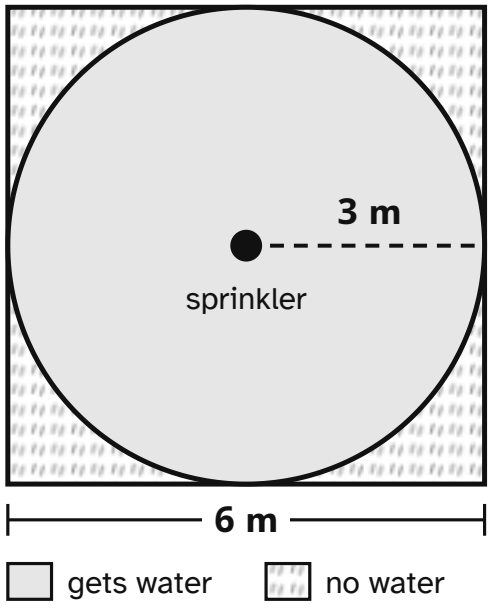
A sprinkler stands in the centre of a square lawn. Each side of the lawn is 6 m.

The sprinkler waters a circle with a radius of 3 m.

Use π = 3.14.

Show that more than three quarters of the lawn gets water.

Working



Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

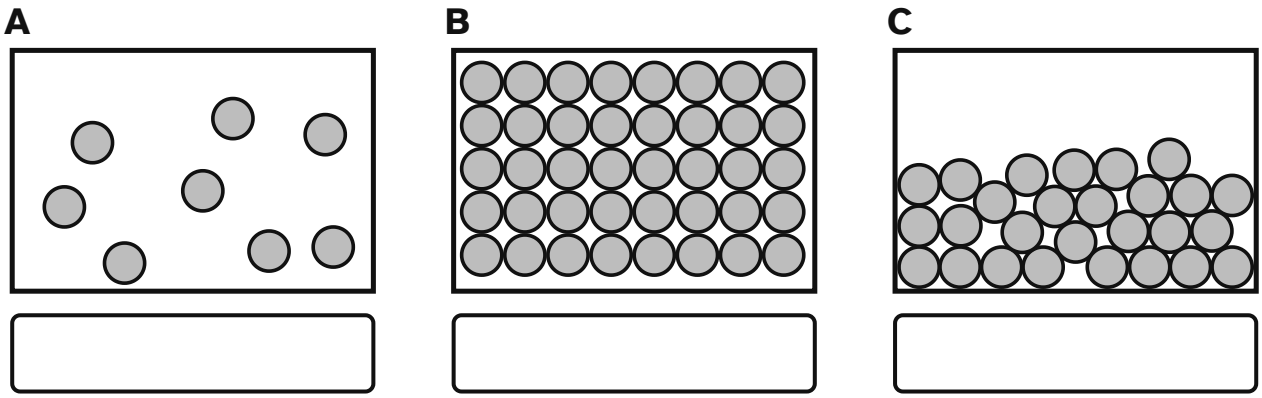
Science

You have 8 minutes.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

1 / 2

a. **Write** solid, liquid or gas in the box under each picture.

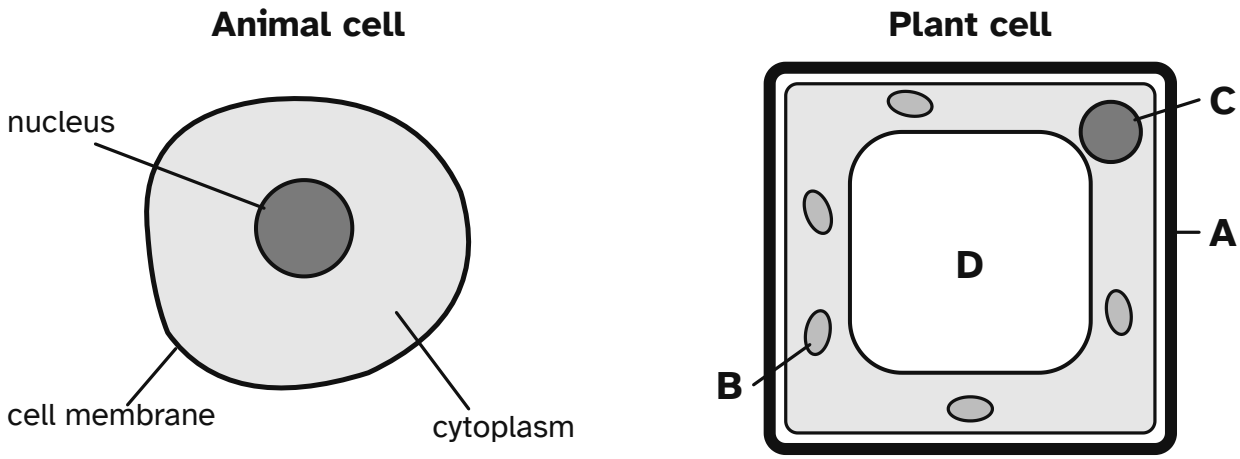


b. Ice is heated and it melts. What happens to the energy of its particles? **Tick** one box.

☐ It increases. ☐ It decreases. ☐ It stays the same.

2 / 1

Mei looks at cells with a microscope. She draws an animal cell and a plant cell.



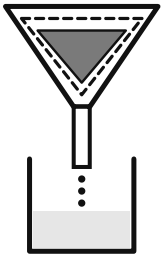
Write the letter of one part that the plant cell has and the animal cell does **not** have.

3 / 1

Aisha has a mixture of sand and salt. She wants to get dry salt.

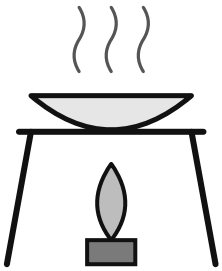
Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to put the steps in order.

A



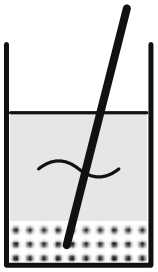
filter

B



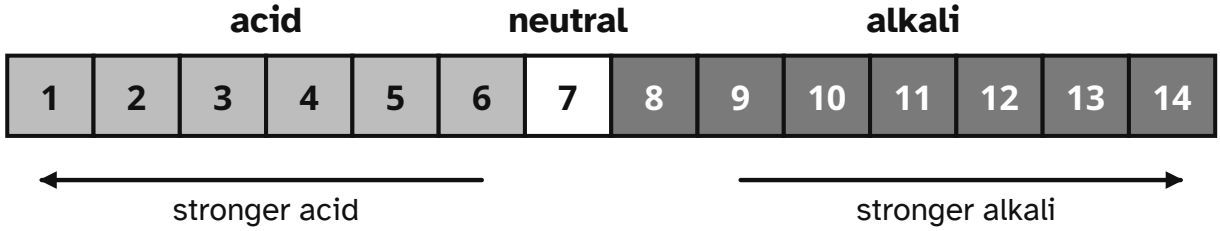
evaporate

C



add water and stir

4 / 2

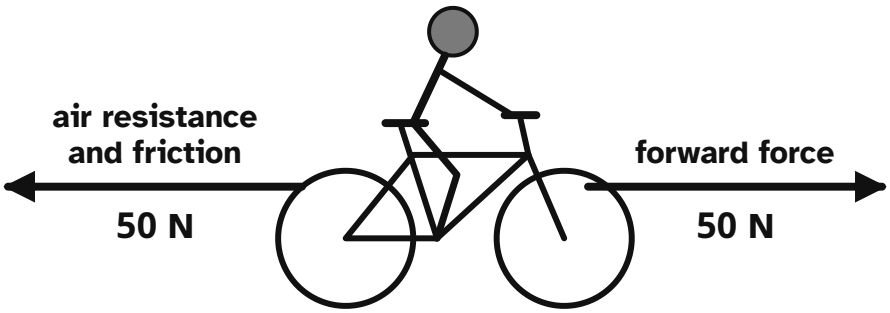


Substance	lemon juice	vinegar	pure water	toothpaste	soap
pH	2	3	7	9	10

a. Which substance in the table is the strongest acid? _____

b. **Write** the name of one alkali in the table. _____

5 / 2



a. The two forces are balanced. What happens to the girl's speed? **Tick** one box.

☐ It goes up. ☐ It stays the same. ☐ It goes down.

b. She travels 100 m in 20 seconds. **Work out** her speed.

speed = distance ÷ time ☐ m/s

6 / 1

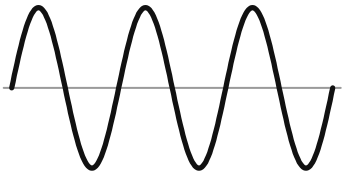
These pictures show three sound waves. Which one is the **loudest** sound? **Tick** one box.

A



☐

B



☐

C



☐

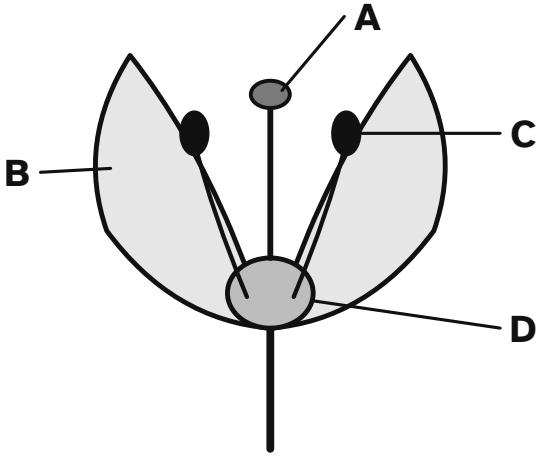
7 / 1

This picture shows the parts of a flower.

Which part makes **pollen**?

Write the letter in the box.

☐



Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 8 grading sheet (version 3.1)

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Date of birth		**Current school**	
Date of assessment		**Assessor**	

Paper version sat: v3.1 (on the front page of the student paper). **For staff only.** Mark the student paper first (every question has a mark box; answers and mark schemes are in `Y08_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`). Copy the totals here and give the bands from the guide below. Reading is recorded on the **Reading front sheet** and speaking on the **Interview sheet**.

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening (Part A / 8, Part B / 8)	A ___ + B ___ = ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Part B not given? ☐
Writing (four criteria, each / 4)	content ___ vocabulary ___ grammar ___ spelling and punctuation ___ = ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Task chosen: 1 2
Maths (Fluency / 10, Word questions / 8, Applied / 12)	F ___ + W ___ + A ___ = ___ / 30	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	NT: L:
Science (/ 10)	___ / 10	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	NT: L:
Reading	Reading front sheet		
Speaking	Interview sheet		

Maths profile. Fluency ___ % · Word questions ___ % · Applied ___ %.

☐ Fluency much higher than word questions: was the barrier English? (A word question solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.)

☐ Fluency and word questions much higher than applied: needs teaching in problem solving and explaining.

Not yet taught (NT) topics, and the likely maths and science band once taught:

Access arrangements (extra time, reader, breaks) and **behaviour and wellbeing** during the assessment:

Assessor's comment (strengths, English barrier or not, what support the student would need, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____

Band guide at a glance (full guide and judgement notes: `Y08_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`)

Band	Listening (/ 16)	Writing (/ 16; best fit decides)	Maths (/ 30)	Science (/ 10)
A or **1**	Part A 0 to 2	0 to 3	1 Below expected: 0 to 10	1: 0 to 3
B or **2**	Part A 3 to 4	4 to 7	2 Working towards: 11 to 16	2: 4 to 5
C or **3**	Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	8 to 10	3 Expected: 17 to 22	3: 6 to 8
D or **4**	Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	11 to 13	4 Greater depth: 23 to 30	4: 9 to 10
E	Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	14 to 16		

Reading front sheet: reading levels and sentence reading

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Age today (years:months)		**Date**	

For staff only. One sheet for each candidate, all year groups. The assessor fills in Part 1 and gives this sheet to the interviewer (usually the principal) before the interview. The interviewer, or in Years 1 to 3 the assessor, runs the sentence reading with `Sentence_Reading_Guide` and records it in Part 2. Part 3 gives the reading result for the final mark sheet.

1. Reading levels so far (the assessor fills this in)

Item	Details
Handed over by, and time	Handed over by _____ at _____ Received by _____
Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen (its Sheet 13)	Letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 Phonics words ___ / 40 Tricky words ___ / 20 Book band _____ (Oxford Level ___) Accuracy ___ % Questions ___ / ___
Years 4 to 6: reading paper	Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Part C ___ / 8 Total ___ / 24
Years 7 to 12: reading paper	Part A ___ / 8 Part B ___ / 8 Total ___ / 16 Stopped at 15 minutes at question ___
Reading band so far	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D ☐ E
Sentence reading starts at	☐ the level for the year group (table below) ☐ Level 1, because the student is new to English
Tell the interviewer	(for example: shy, needs more time, stopped early, anxious about English)

Year group	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level (first sentence)	1 (1)	1 (1)	2 (4)	3 (7)	4 (10)	5 (13)	6 (16)	7 (19)	8 (22)	9 (25)	9 (25)	9 (25)

2. Sentence reading (Graded Sentence Reading Screen)

Run by: ☐ interviewer ☐ assessor (Years 1 to 3, after the Early Reading Screen). Write 2, 1 or 0 for each sentence (none, one, two or more errors), then the meaning check and the level total. **Levels below the start level:** write 6 in the total if the student scored 6 out of 6 on the start level (guide, Section 1). **Stop** at the end of a level with 2 points or fewer, after three 0s in a row, or if the student is upset.

Level	Sentence a	Sentence b	Sentence c	Meaning check	Level total
1 (sentences 1 to 3)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
2 (4 to 6)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
3 (7 to 9)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
4 (10 to 12)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
5 (13 to 15)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
6 (16 to 18)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
7 (19 to 21)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
8 (22 to 24)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
9 (25 to 27)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
10 (28 to 30)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
11 (31 to 33)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6
12 (34 to 36)				☐ ✓ ☐ ½ ☐ ✗	/ 6

Errors, what the student said when you are not sure, and **patterns noticed** (S substitution, O omission, I insertion, T told; SC self-correction is not an error). Patterns such as missing -ed or -s endings, or pinyin letter values, are useful evidence:

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3. Result (copy to the final mark sheet)

Measure	Result
Total points (including 6 for each level below the start level that was not read)	___ / 72
Reading age (5:00 plus 2 months for every point: 6 points = 6:00, 12 = 7:00, 30 = 10:00, 60 = 15:00, 72 = 17:00)	_____ : _____
Actual age (years:months) and difference (reading age minus actual age)	Actual _____ : _____ Difference _____ months
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	___ asked, ___ ✓
Fluency on the last level read with 4 or more points (1 word by word, 2 two or three words, 3 sensible phrases, 4 smooth)	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4
Indicative reading band from the sentence reading (table below)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading band for the final mark sheet (the Early Reading Screen in Years 1 to 3, the reading paper in Years 4 to 12; if it differs from the sentence reading by more than one band, say why)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Band from the reading age (the full guide and the notes are in `Sentence_Reading_Guide`)

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12	Band
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below	up to 12 months below	**E**
Below	7 to 12 months below	13 to 24 months below	**D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below	25 to 42 months below	**C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below	43 to 60 months below	**B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below	more than 60 months below	**A**

Years 1 and 2: use the reading age as supporting evidence only. If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one (decoding ahead of understanding).

Interview sheet: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date**	
Interviewer		**Others present**	

Questions and descriptors: `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`. Sentence reading is recorded on the Reading front sheet. For staff only.

Speaking and listening

Speaking band: ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

Key things the student said (their own words, and how they said it)

Suitability

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Strand	Rating	Evidence (a short quotation or what you saw)
Attitude to learning and resilience	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Boarding readiness (only if the student will board)	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions, and what the student would need in the first weeks:

Interviewer's comment for the final mark sheet

Strengths, concerns, support:

Interviewer signature and date _____

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Final mark sheet: candidate summary and decision

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Current school		**Date of assessment**	

Paper version sat: _____ (v3.1; on the front page of the student paper). Complete within two working days from the **grading sheet**, **Reading front sheet**, **Interview sheet**, parent conversation record and homeroom teacher reference. This is the one overview that the head of section reads and that goes into the admissions system. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (copy the scores)	Band
Listening	Grading sheet: ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation (Interview sheet)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Speaking	Interview sheet (and picture talk on the grading sheet, Years 1 to 3)	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading	Reading front sheet. Years 1 to 3: book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics ___ / 40 ; letters ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: paper ___ / 24. Years 7 to 12: paper ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Reading aloud	Sentence reading (Reading front sheet): points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative ☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Writing	Grading sheet: ___ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 12: fluency) / word problems (word questions) / applied (Years 7 to 12)	Not yet taught (NT) and language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	___ / ___ ___ / ___ ___ / 12	
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4		

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 12: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 12 papers are harder, so their boundaries are lower. Strong number problems with weak word problems may be an English barrier, not a maths difficulty. Years 7 to 12: strong fluency and word questions with weak applied problems means teaching in problem solving, not more content. NT questions score 0: say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Years 10 and 11: readiness for IGCSE (grading sheet; Section 6 of the year's instructions). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet ☐ (Year 11) start in Year 10.

Years 11 and 12: optional sciences and cognitive ability screen (grading sheet). Biology ___ / 15 band ___ Chemistry ___ / 15 band ___ Physics ___ / 15 band ___ (blank if not taken). Cognitive screen: non-verbal ___ / 12 quantitative ___ / 12 verbal ___ / 12 processing speed ___ / 60. Profile note: _____ (for planning

support, never for selection). **Year 12: readiness for A Level** (Section 6 of the Year 12 instructions): ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Pre-A Level year advised ☐ Not yet.

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Interview sheet (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Comments and feedback

Assessor (from the grading sheet): strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not.

Interviewer (from the Interview sheet): what the student is like, hopes and plans, anything of concern.

Feedback for the family. Start with the child's strengths; use plain words; say what support we will give and, if no offer is made, what would change the decision.

7. Sign-off and records

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Interviewer			
Head of section			
Admissions: outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			

Papers filed together: ☐ grading sheet ☐ Reading front sheet ☐ Interview sheet ☐ parent conversation record ☐ marked student paper. Assessment result and report given with the marked papers on: _____
Entered in the admissions system: date _____ initials _____

Assessment result and report

Candidate name		**Candidate number**	
Year group applied for		**Date of birth**	
Current school		**Date of assessment**	

Paper version sat: _____ Assessor: _____ Interviewer: _____ Report date: _____

Outcome (from the final mark sheet, confirmed by the head of section): ☐ Offer ☐ Offer with English support ☐ Offer with a learning plan ☐ Further assessment before a decision ☐ Unable to offer at this time. Year group confirmed: _____

Results

	Score	Band	What we found (a few words)
Listening	__ / __	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Speaking (interview)		☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Reading	__ / __ reading age _____	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	Book band (Years 1 to 3):
Writing	__ / 16	☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Overall English		☐A ☐B ☐C ☐D ☐E	
Maths	__ / __	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	Topics not yet taught:
Science (Years 5 to 10)	__ / __	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Strengths

What to work on

Support we recommend from the first day (English support, maths and science catch-up, where to start reading)

Next step and review date

Head of section (name, signature, date) _____

Admissions (name, signature, date) _____

The bands show where the student is now and what support will help. They are not a pass mark. The back of this sheet explains them.

About this report

This report goes with the student's marked papers. It was made from the grading sheet, the reading and interview sheets and the parent conversation. The assessment was in English only, so the English bands show how far the student's English has come, and maths and science show what the student can do when the English is not the barrier. Some topics are taught in a different order in Chinese schools: where a student has not yet been taught a topic it scores 0 and the report says so.

The English bands

Band	Listening	Speaking	Reading	Writing
A New to English	Understands little or no English; may follow a routine instruction with gesture.	Silent, or single words and memorised phrases; may use Chinese.	May know some letter names or sounds; reads few or no words.	Copies, writes their name, or writes isolated words; may write in Chinese.
B Early acquisition	Understands simple, slow questions and instructions on familiar topics, with support.	Short phrases and simple sentences about familiar things; frequent errors.	Decodes simple words and short sentences; understands very simple texts with pictures.	Short simple sentences with familiar words; frequent errors in grammar and spelling; meaning mostly clear in short pieces.
C Developing competence	Follows most everyday talk and simple explanations; misses detail and implied meaning.	Connected sentences with "because", "but", "so"; errors common but meaning usually clear; everyday vocabulary.	Reads simple texts two or more years below age level with understanding; struggles with age-level texts.	A short connected piece; some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; basic punctuation.
D Competent	Follows most classroom talk at normal pace, including some implied meaning.	Speaks at length, explains and gives examples; occasional errors.	Reads age-level texts with some difficulty in vocabulary and inference.	Organised writing with a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; varied vocabulary.
E Fluent	Understands as a fluent speaker of the same age does.	Fluent and accurate for age.	Reads age-level texts as a fluent reader of the same age does.	Writing comparable to a fluent writer of the same age.

Reading age is an indicative figure from a short reading-aloud screen: 5 years 0 months plus 2 months for every point. It is a guide, not a standardised test.

Maths and science bands compare the score with what is expected for the year group: 1 Well below expected, 2 Working towards, 3 Expected, 4 Greater depth. The papers for older students are harder, so their boundaries are lower.

If you have questions about this report, contact the admissions office.